



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Oaks: A Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://theoakscga.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Oaks Classical Christian Academy WA 99214 (The Oaks) presents a robust classical Christian program that centers faith, virtue formation, and a Trivium-based curriculum. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a biblical worldview, theology as foundational to all disciplines, and liturgical/community practices, alongside a clearly articulated Trivium pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a strong emphasis on memorization, primary sources, and Great Books-like reading. The school also foregrounds parental partnership, discipleship, and a family-based culture with ongoing opportunities for parent formation and campus involvement. Taken together, these signals align strongly with classical education as outlined in the Six Essential Elements framework.

- Foundational religious/theological framing and liturgical/community practices are evident in mission statements, statements of faith, and explicit references to Christian worship and prayer as part of daily life.
- The curricular structure and pedagogy explicitly mirror the classical Trivium with emphasis on primary sources, memorization, and a memory-centered culture, as well as a focus on virtue and formation.
- Parental partnership and a school culture oriented toward virtue, character formation, and community life are repeatedly highlighted.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission statements emphasize partnering with parents to graduate classically educated students who glorify Christ and shine God's truth in every endeavor.
- Daily Bible study, a biblically centered curriculum, and theology-organized instruction are described across grade levels.
- Liturgical and communal practices (prayer, discipleship, a life rooted in Christian doctrine) are described as integral to the school culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators drawn from classical-lexicon frameworks include truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, worship, and discipleship. The Oaks' materials repeatedly reference biblical truth, theology, and worship practices, aligning with these signals. The lexicon supports these as core, not peripheral, signals of a classical/metaphysical orientation.
- Negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism, values-neutrality) are not present in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated mission and practices center a biblical worldview, theology-informed integration across disciplines, and liturgical/community worship, all of which strongly satisfy the transcendental moral realism and liturgical foundations highlighted in classical pedagogy resources.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Core purpose described as formation and shaping character within a classical Christian framework, not mere job-preparation. The Oaks emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and the formation of human excellence within a classical mission.
- The program explicitly situates education as formation (grammar, logic, rhetoric) aligned with a long historical tradition, not simply information transfer.
- Mentions of Great Books/primary sources and a goal of human flourishing through a biblically informed education appear in the curriculum descriptions and reading practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (from the Six Elements lexicon): formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, Great Books/primary sources, human flourishing. The Oaks materials consistently show formation and virtue as end goals.
- Negative keywords (e.g., “workforce preparation,” “21st-century skills”) do not appear in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The Oaks clearly adopts the classical aim of forming character, virtue, and wisdom, with explicit emphasis on formation over mere information and a telos-oriented view of education. This aligns with the Classical paradigm’s purpose and goals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Explicit adoption of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across K–12, with a developmental progression and orchestration of related activities (Progymnasmata, rhetoric courses, thesis projects).
- Eight-year Latin foundation; focus on primary sources; emphasis on reading and engaged, disciplined study (rather than social studies-centric framing).
- Curriculum materials reference Great Books/primary sources, and a block of subjects designed around classical humanities (Bible, history, literature, logic, rhetoric).
- Emphasis on the “two-millennia” classical model and attention to classical texts (Dorothy Sayers reference; pro-gymnasmata) indicates adherence to classical curriculum norms.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin, history/Western civilization, rhetoric, memorization, Pro Gymnasmata, seminars, and thesis projects. The Oaks materials demonstrate these curricular elements.
- Negative keywords: terms signaling a non-classical or project-based only approach are not apparent in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum explicitly matches classical education expectations: Trivium, Great Books/primary sources, Latin, memory-work, and primary-source-driven history/literature; thus CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, and memory work; upper-school includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, including thesis presentations.
- Progymnasmata-based writing instruction and classical memory/recitation approaches are described in curriculum materials.
- Emphasis on contemplative/restful learning (Scholé), wonder, and a mix of rigorous and restful educational moments is present in the pedagogical narrative.
- The public materials emphasize Socratic seminars and rhetoric as core upper-element pedagogy, with a clearly staged move from grammar to logic to rhetoric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, questioning, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, chanting, singing, progymnasmata, memory work, seminar, rhetoric, capstone/orations, and scholé/restful learning. The Oaks public materials repeatedly mention these formats.

- Negative keywords present: none of the listed negative signals (experiential-only, project-based-only, constructivist, etc.) are evident in the materials.
- Why this rating
- Pedagogy combines contemplative, memory-centered practices with high-level Socratic discourse and rhetoric training, aligning with classical pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty are described as highly experienced, with many years of service and advanced degrees; the living-curriculum concept is invoked, with faculty acting as mentors and exemplars.
- Descriptions of faculty longevity, master's degrees, and mentorship culture appear in admission-/teaching descriptions.
- There are explicit references to "portrait of a teacher" and "faculty as living curriculum" in some Oaks materials, indicating a characterization of teachers as central to the school's classical mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core/community, collegial culture, lifelong learners. These terms appear across Oaks materials.
- Negative keywords: none observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The published materials consistently frame teachers as central to the school's classical formation, aligning with the classical model's expectation of faculty as a living curriculum and virtuous exemplars.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Oaks emphasizes partnering with parents, co-teaching with families, and parental formation through reading groups and seminars; open-campus and family involvement are highlighted.
- The school references a family-centric culture, with opportunities for parent involvement, visits, and a shared life of faith and learning (A Way of Life; discipleship; prayer).
- Public materials describe parent formation and the school's intention to educate parents about classical education; parent participation is welcomed frequently.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading group-/book studies, open campus, family liturgy alignment, parent involvement. These are central to classical-community signals in the lexicon.
- Negative keywords: absence of consumer/customer framing; no explicit negative signals detected in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The Oaks demonstrates a strong, ongoing commitment to parent partnership and community formation, in line with classical education expectations for a family-centered, communal, liturgical environment.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

- The Oaks displays a consistent alignment with classical education across all six categories, with explicit Trivium pedagogy, primary-source-driven curricula, strong religious/theological foundations, clear formation-oriented goals, and active parent-community partnerships. The presence of liturgical/community practices, the central role of the teacher as mentor, and the deliberate integration of faith with learning reinforce the Classical orientation throughout the school's public materials. Citations reflect statements about mission, curriculum, pedagogy, and community from Oaks materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- N/A (All six categories align with CLASSICAL signals based on current materials.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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